ELECTRIC DREAMS

BYD HAS LAUNCHED AN EXCITING NEW PRODUCT, THE SEALION 7 SUV. BUT IS IT GOOD ENOUGH TO TAKE ON THE BIGWIGS OF THE AUTOMOTIVE WORLD?

BY RAHUL GHOSH

BYD, or Build Your Dreams, has been in India for a long time. More famous for its Blade Battery pack, the company is now offering the Sealion 7.

The Sealion 7 is based on BYD's e-Platform 3.0 and uses the tried and well-tested Blade Battery pack. The platform allows RWD as well as AWD set-ups. In the design department, BYD refers to it as the Ocean Series—interpreted as smooth-flowing lines. The SUV comes with a sleek front-end design, complete with sharp LED headlamps. The bumper houses sharp cuts which serve as aero aids. In profile, one notices that the SUV is rather large. Massive 20-inch wheels fill up the wheel wells, and the design for the alloys is also cool. The sweeping roofline and the spoiler at the back add to its sporty character. The rear end features a smart and simple look with connected tail lights.

BYD Sealion 7 4.5 AWD
Motor: Dual-motor, AWD
Power: 523 bhp
Torque: 690Nm
Transmission: Single-speed
Battery: 82.56kWh
Range: 542 km (NEDC)
Top Speed: NA
Price: ₹54.90 lakh (ex-showroom) On sale now

Smooth and sophisticated is how we would like to refer to the Sealion 7's interiors. The dash is one seamless panel that plays coloured themes. The infotainment system is a massive 15.6-inch unit, which is electrically rotatable. The well-designed unit is also paired with a brilliant 12-speaker Dynaudio system. The all-digital instrument panel is excellent, too. Thanks to the plethora of cameras and sensors, the system picks up types of traffic around and dispays it on the screen. This can be particularly handy while driving in foggy conditions.

The centre console comes with a set of controls, which are easy to use. Further down, there is a 50-watt wireless charging pad that has an integrated cooler for the device. There is additional space next to it for a second phone as well. The electrically adjustable and ventilated seats are extremely comfortable. Space is the BYD Sealion's forte, and it is evident when one steps into the back seat. The boot can take in 500 litres of cargo. The SUV also comes with a small frunk that can accommodate 58 litres of cargo.

BYD is offering the Sealion 7 in two variants. The entry-level version, the Premium, features an RWD architecture. The power output is rated at 230kW, and the torque generated is 380Nm. The battery pack in this variant is rated at 82.56kWh, and the range offered is 567 km. The top variant is the Performance, and as the name suggests, it features dual motors and is an AWD offering. Maximum power is rated at 390kW, and torque output is 690Nm. BYD claims that this version can travel 542 km on every charge.

When it comes to handling, BYD has done a good job in specing up this 2.3-tonne SUV. The Sealion 7 takes on corners with confidence, and the steering in performance modes offers decent feedback. Body roll is also well-controlled, although prevalent. ■



HARVINDER SINGH

BYD SEALION 7